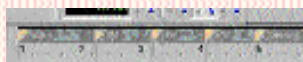


Markers made easy

Add Markers in real-time during playback by pressing [F11]. Rename them afterwards by right-clicking on them. This dialogue also lets you adjust their position precisely by creating them at specified time locations.



SONAR markers divide your song into vocals, chorus, verse, etc

Using the Drum Grid pane

SONAR's Drum Grid pane makes editing drum tracks and patterns a snap. MIDI drum tracks usually sound unrealistic, unless you use timing and velocity information—SONAR makes it easy to edit these parameters in a single window. Use the Drum Grid Pane to add or delete notes, paint them in with the new Pattern Brush, and modify any note property.

To display tracks in the Drum Grid, create or load a drum map by selecting **Options > Drum Map Manager**. If you want to create a totally new drum map, click the Create New Drum Map button in the Current Project field. Change the focus to the Track view. Select the tracks you want to view in the Drum Grid Editor and select **View > Piano Roll**. The Piano Roll view appears with the selected track's data in the Drum Grid Editor. Use the

Pattern Brush tool to produce a series of notes in the Drum Grid pane. The type of notes that appear in the Drum Grid depends on the settings you make in the Pattern Brush tool's dropdown menu. To open the Pattern Brush tool's dropdown menu, click the arrow on the tool's icon.

SoundForge

This is an excellent WAV file recording, editing and filtering tool. SoundForge lets you non-destructively cut and paste audio without any headaches and also allows you to add effects processing that was previously only possible with a large rack of expensive studio gear

Removing pops and hisses

Sounds that you've put together don't always come out squeaky clean. Many times you'll have noticeable pops or hisses that weren't intended to be a part of the ensemble. This mostly occurs when the sound has been recorded at too high a level or if the input source audio is of low quality. To remedy this, you can either reduce the volume and re-record it at a correct level, or normalise the audio by bringing it to the correct level. Click **Process > Normalize** and specify a volume level (in per cent) lower than that of the original sample—it should be 80 per cent of the original sample.

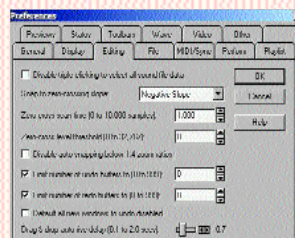
This will help get rid of any crackling and hissing present in the source file.

Speed up your SoundForge sessions

This tip works especially well if you're working with a very large audio file. There is a way to speed up the processing of SoundForge, but it's not useful in all situations because it involves disabling the Undo function. Be wary though; without the Undo function, there is no way for you to reverse any of the processing that you apply to your audio data. At the very least, you should make a backup copy of your original audio file before you attempt to do any editing.

To disable the Undo function click **Options > Preferences** to open the Preferences dialog box. Click on the Editing tab. Activate the Limit Number Of Undo Buffers To option and enter a value of 0. Click OK, and exit SoundForge.

Now any processing you do in your files will be permanent, but it will be completed much faster. You

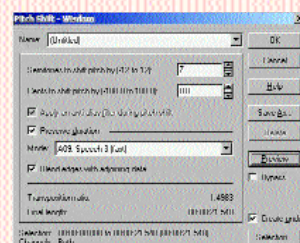


Set the number of Undo and Redo buffers to 0

can use the time you save to make even more music!

The chipmunk effect

The chipmunk effect can be achieved by simply changing the vocal pitch to a higher frequency. The trick is in keeping the part the same length, because when you increase the pitch of audio, you normally shorten the length of the recording. Here's how to get around this problem: Select the audio data. Select **Effects > Pitch > Shift**.



Create cool vocal effects with the Pitch Shift effect

Set the Semitones parameter to 7, and leave the Cents parameter at 0. Activate the Apply An Anti-Alias option. Activate the Preserve Duration option. Select Speech 3 in the Mode list. Click OK. Click on the Preview button to check out the changes before you apply them.

The Darth Vader effect

You can also use pitch changes to achieve the opposite of the chipmunk effect. Instead of the light and cheery sound, you can lower the pitch of your vocals to get



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